



FROST DATES & SEASON

- Last frost:** January 31 or earlier; many areas frost-free year-round
- First frost:** December 15 or later; many areas frost-free
- Season:** 300–365 days (essentially year-round)

THIS MONTH — MAY 2026

1. Cool-season crops are finishing fast — harvest all remaining lettuce, spinach, peas & broccoli now and clear the beds.
2. Okra, southern peas & sweet potatoes are the priority. Succession-sow okra through April for a staggered harvest.
3. Plan your July–August strategy: mulch heavily, solarize empty beds, and start fall crops indoors in late July.

QUICK-START CROPS

- Everglades tomato (H)**
Native South Florida cherry tomato, essentially perennial in Zone 10. Prolific, disease-resistant, heat-set. Self-sows.
- Seminole pumpkin (H)**
Native to Florida, bred for Zone 10 conditions. Resists vine borers, stores 12 months, sprawling vine.
- Malabar spinach (OP)**
The heat-loving vine that fills the spinach role in Zone 10 summer. Productive trellis plant, very easy to grow.

STORAGE & PRESERVATION

- Cool-season window (Oct–April) is the primary preservation season — process spring tomatoes and root vegetables while temperatures allow.
- Tropical fruit preservation is the Zone 10 opportunity: dehydrated mango, fig preserves, and avocado products are high-value shelf-stable items.
- Fermented hot sauce is ideal for Zone 10's prolific hot pepper harvest — Zone 10 temperatures accelerate lacto-fermentation.

ZONE
10

South Florida, Coastal
Southern California, Hawaii

Miami FL · San Diego CA · Honolulu HI

HEIRLOOM VARIETY SPOTLIGHT

Everglades cherry tomato (H)
Native Florida heirloom. Produces through conditions that kill standard tomatoes. Marble-sized, intensely sweet. Self-sows.

Seminole pumpkin (H)
Historically significant Florida heirloom. Pest-resistant, 12-month storage without refrigeration, heat-adapted.

Datil pepper (H)
St. Augustine FL's locally famous hot pepper. Habanero heat with fruitier flavor. The defining Zone 10 Florida pepper for sauces.